PRIMARY HEALTH CARE

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Intended learning outcome

- By the end of the lecture the student will be able to:
  - Define Health for all & PHC
  - List the Components of PHC.
  - Identify principles of primary health care.
  - List Function of the PHC

Concept and definition of Health for all

- **Health for All (HFA) simply means health services for all, i.e. basic, essential, utilitarian services to be provided to all, irrespective of caste, creed, community and ability to pay for it.**

- **Health for All was defined as, 'Attainment by all the people of the world, a level of health, which will enable or permit every individual to lead socially and economically a productive life' (useful life).**

- **The concept of primary health care has been accepted by all countries to achieve the goal Health for all.**

Definition of primary health care (PHC)(WHO 1978):

- **"Is the essential health care based on practical, scientifically sound and socially accepted methods and technology made universally accessible to individuals and families in the community through their full participation and a cost that the community and the country can afford to maintain at every state of their development in the spirit of self reliance and self determination".**

- **Integral part of a country's health system → central function and main focus and of overall social and economic development of the community.**

- **First level of contact for individuals, families, and communities with the national health system. Brings health care close to where people live and work.**

- **Primary health care is equally valid for all countries, developed and developing**

- **Provides a comprehensive package of promotive, preventive, and curative services (8 elements).**

- **Delivery of services depends on:**
  - **Priority community needs**
  - **Stage of socio-economic and health development**
  - **Available resources**

Elements of Primary Health Care (i.e. Components)

Promotive elements

- **Health Education concerning prevailing health problems and the methods of preventing and controlling them.**
- **Promotion of food supply and proper nutrition.**
- **Provision of comprehensive maternal and childcare.**

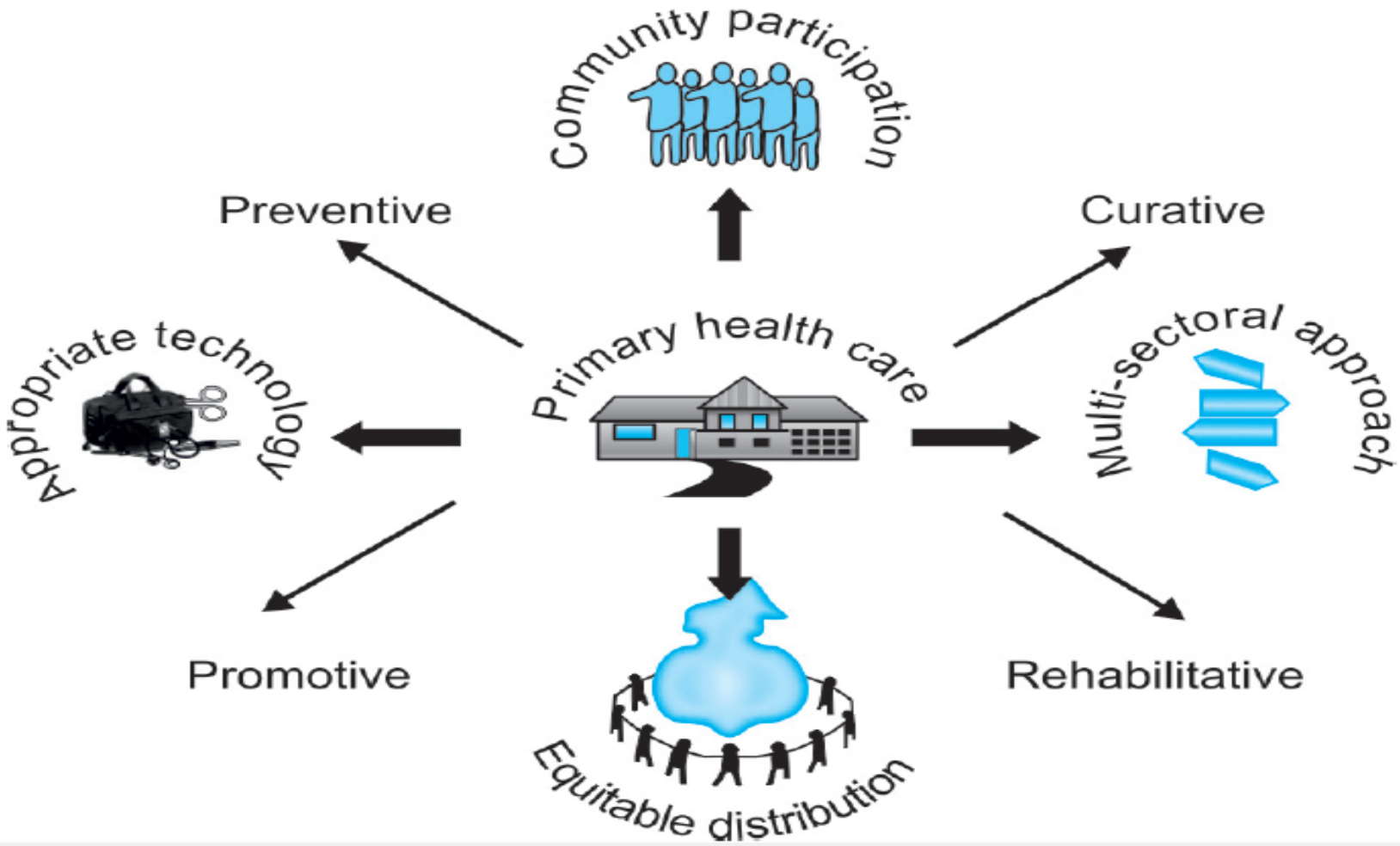
Preventive elements

- Immunization of children against major communicable diseases.
- Prevention and control of locally endemic diseases.
- Provision of adequate supply of safe water.

Curative last two elements

- Appropriate treatment of common diseases and injures.
- Provision of essential drugs.

(PHC principles)



Equity:

- **mean services for all and more services to the needy and vulnerable.**
  - **Vulnerable groups are to be identified and reached through outreach program.**
- **Accessibility has to be improved by:**
  - **Increasing number of facilities.**
  - **Improving transport conditions.**
  - **Organizing outreach services.**

Appropriate technology:

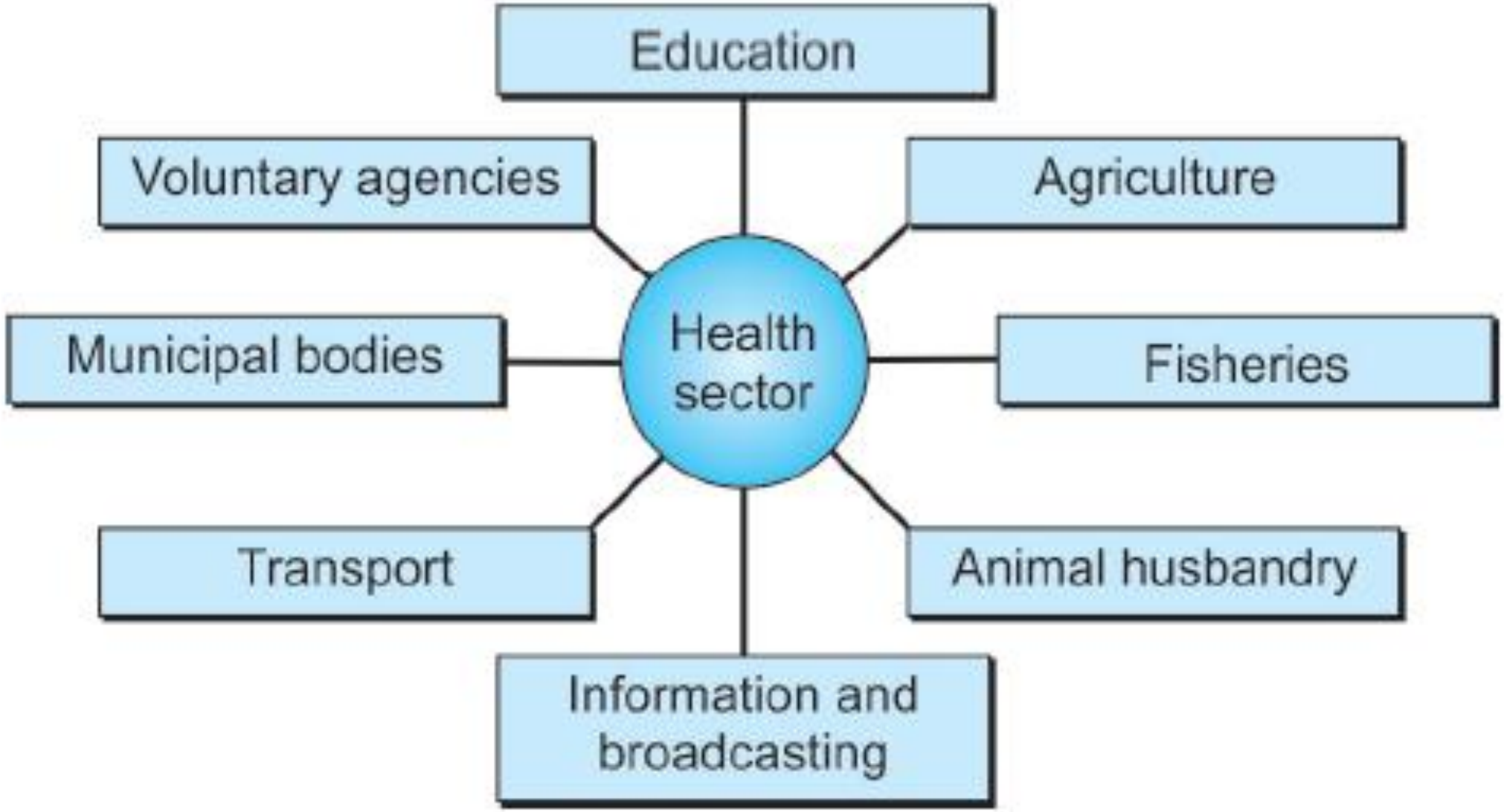
- **appropriate means that besides being scientifically sound is also acceptable to those who apply it and to those for whom it is used.**

- **Examples include:**
  - **ORT in diarrheal disease control.**
  - **Domiciliary treatment in TB control.**
  - **Breast-feeding in spacing.**
  - **Weighing for growth monitoring.**

Multi-sectoral approach:

- **Individual sectors cannot function in isolation. Mutual roles and coordination should be considered.**

- **Examples:**
  - **The role of municipalities in environmental sanitation.**
  - **Provision of portable water and disposal of wastes.**
  - **Ministry of education in school health.**


Education
Voluntary agencies
Agriculture
Municipal bodies
Health sector
Fisheries
Transport
Animal husbandry
Information and broadcasting

Community participation:

- **Community participation**: social **awareness and community self-reliance are the key factor in human development.**
- **Examples include:**
  - **Involving people in PHC activities for planning, implementation, and evaluation of services.**
  - **Provide a source of free labour.**
  - **Financial contribution.**

Advantages of community participation

- **It is a cost-effective method of providing health services.**
- **People begin to view health more objectively. So they are more likely to accept the care.**
- **There will be greater commitment of the people resulting in the success of health care services.**
- **Health awareness becomes an integral part of village life.**

- **Health workers get greater support for their activities.**
- **People become more soft reliant in taking care of their health.**
- **Health care services become more relevant to the health needs of the people.**
- **There is less dependence on the Government.**
- **Quality of the health care improves.**

Strategies For Primary Health Care Implementation

- **The term strategy is derived from military vocabulary meaning' the art of projecting and directing the large military movement and operation of campaign'.**
- **By instituting measures for horizontal expansion and insure efficiency in health services delivery in general.**
- **By developing good rapport between the health centres and the beneficiaris:**
  - **by organizing out-reach activities and**
  - **reaching the people through social and religious institutions (like school, mosque, etc.) and**
  - **explore/study the social problems related to health.**

- **By motivating the people to accept health centres as an institution of delivering comprehensive health care and not merely the dispensers of drugs and to motivate them to opt for preventive and primitive services with the participation of the community itself.**

- **By consolidating and strengthening the national control programmes (malaria, billharazia); by integrating preventive and curative services.**

- **By promoting health awareness in the people through organized health education programmes, institutional and out-reach; towards better utilization of health services and to participate with the health centres in solving health and environmental problems.**

- **By developing effective coordination with other health service delivery institutions like hospital; by evolving a suitable referral system.**

- **By coordinating with the educational and training institutions (universal, health institutes etc.) for the introduction of PHC in academic curriculum and to involve them in the continued educational programmes for the professionals of health centres.**

- **By coordinating with health related government sectors such as; ministers of agriculture, municipalities, education for improvement of the health institution related to services.**

- **By providing better quality of services to the high-risk group of the community such as; pregnant mothers, preschool children and others.**

Instruments in delivery of PHC:

- **Community surveys and diagnosis.**
- **Family health records.**
- **Plan of action.**
- **Team approach.**
- **Information system.**

Functions of the Primary Health care

1. Improvement of environmental sanitation with special emphasis on safe water supply
2. Food supply and proper nutrient
3. MCH services including family planning
4. Prevention and control of communicable diseases (Immunization)
5. Prevention and control of endemics and implementation of relevant National Health Programs

6. Health education

7. Treatment of disease and injuries

8. Training programs for health workers, health assistants, local dais, etc.

9. Collection and reporting of vital statistics

10. Basic laboratory services

11. Referral services

Thank you